



**University  
of Victoria**

# **Happiness Questionnaires**

**Department of Computer Science**

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Per the definition of happiness in psychology, our study will measure three things: positive affect, negative affect, and satisfaction (domain and global life satisfaction). To gather such a measurement we will use a combination of questionnaires from those shared below.

# SATISFACTION WITH LIFE SCALE

## Reference:

Diener, E., Emmons, R. A., Larsen, R. J., & Griffin, S. (1985). The Satisfaction with Life Scale. *Journal of Personality Assessment*, 49, 71-75.

## Description of Measure:

A 5-item scale designed to measure global cognitive judgments of one's life satisfaction (not a measure of either positive or negative affect).

Participants indicate how much they agree or disagree with each of the 5 items using a 7-point scale that ranges from 7 strongly agree to 1 strongly disagree.

## Abstracts of Selected Related Articles:

Pavot, W. G., Diener, E., Colvin, C. R., & Sandvik, E. (1991). Further validation of the Satisfaction with Life Scale: Evidence for the cross-method convergence of well-being measures. *Journal of Personality Assessment*, 57, 149-161.

The structure of subjective well-being has been conceptualized as consisting of two major components: the emotional or affective component and the judgmental or cognitive component (Diener, 1984; Veenhoven, 1984). The judgmental component has also been conceptualized as life satisfaction (Andrews & Withey, 1976). Although the affective component of subjective well-being has received considerable attention from researchers, the judgmental component has been relatively neglected. The Satisfaction With Life Scale (SWLS; Diener, Emmons, Larsen, & Griffin, 1985) was developed as a measure of the judgmental component of subjective well-being (SWB). Two studies designed to validate further the SWLS are reported. Peer reports, a memory measure, and clinical ratings are used as external criteria for validation. Evidence for the reliability and predictive validity of the SWLS is presented, and its performance is compared to other related scales. The SWLS is shown to be a valid and reliable measure of life satisfaction, suited for use with a wide range of age groups and applications, which makes possible the savings of interview time and resources compared to many measures of life satisfaction. In addition, the high convergence of self- and peer-reported measures of subjective well-being and life satisfaction provide strong evidence that subjective well-being is a relatively global and stable phenomenon, not simply a momentary judgment based on fleeting influences.

Pavot, W. G., & Diener, E. (1993). Review of the Satisfaction with Life Scale. *Psychological Assessment*, 5, 164-172.

The Satisfaction With Life Scale (SWLS) was developed to assess satisfaction with the respondent's life as a whole. The scale does not assess satisfaction with life domains such as health or finances but allows subjects to integrate and weight these domains in whatever way they choose. Normative data are presented for the scale,

which shows good convergent validity with other scales and with other types of assessments of subjective well-being. Life satisfaction as assessed by the SWLS shows a degree of temporal stability (e.g., .54 for 4 years), yet the SWLS has shown sufficient sensitivity to be potentially valuable to detect change in life satisfaction during the course of clinical intervention. Further, the scale shows discriminant validity from emotional well-being measures. The SWLS is recommended as a complement to scales that focus on psychopathology or emotional well-being because it assesses an individual's conscious evaluative judgment of his or her life by using the person's own criteria.

Diener, E., Sandvik, E., Seidlitz L., Diener, M. (1993). The relationship between income subjective well-being: Relative or absolute? *Social Indicators Research*, 28, 195-223.

Although it appears that income and subjective well-being correlate in within-country studies (Diener, 1984), a debate has focused on whether this relationship is relative (Easterlin, 1974) or absolute (Veenhoven, 1988, 1991). The absolute argument advanced by Veenhoven states that income helps individuals meet certain universal needs and therefore that income, at least at lower levels, is a cause of subjective well-being. The relativity argument is based on the idea that the impact of income or other resources depends on changeable standards such as those derived from expectancies, habituation levels, and social comparisons. Two studies which empirically examine these positions are presented: one based on 18 032 college studies in 39 countries, and one based on 10 year longitudinal data in a probability sample of 4 942 American adults. Modest but significant correlations were found in the U.S. between income and well-being, but the cross-country correlations were larger. No evidence for the influence of relative standards on income was found: (1) Income *change* did not produce effects beyond the effect of income level per se, (2) African-Americans and the poorly educated did not derive greater happiness from specific levels of income, (3) Income produced the same levels of happiness in poorer and richer areas of the U.S., and (4) Affluence correlated with subjective well-being both across countries and within the U.S. Income appeared to produce lesser increases in subjective well-being at higher income levels in the U.S., but this pattern was not evident across countries. Conceptual and empirical questions about the universal needs position are noted. Suggestions for further explorations of the relativistic position are offered.

**Scale:**

*Instructions:* Below are five statements that you may agree or disagree with. Using the 1 - 7 scale below, indicate your agreement with each item by placing the appropriate number on the line preceding that item. Please be open and honest in your responding.

- 7 - Strongly agree
- 6 - Agree
- 5 - Slightly agree
- 4 - Neither agree nor disagree
- 3 - Slightly disagree
- 2 - Disagree
- 1 - Strongly disagree

\_\_\_\_ In most ways my life is close to my ideal.

\_\_\_\_ The conditions of my life are excellent.

\_\_\_\_ I am satisfied with my life.

\_\_\_\_ So far I have gotten the important things I want in life.

\_\_\_\_ If I could live my life over, I would change almost nothing.

**Scoring:**

Though scoring should be kept continuous (sum up scores on each item), here are some cut-offs to be used as benchmarks.

- 31 - 35 Extremely satisfied
- 26 - 30 Satisfied
- 21 - 25 Slightly satisfied
- 20 Neutral
- 15 - 19 Slightly dissatisfied
- 10 - 14 Dissatisfied
- 5 - 9 Extremely dissatisfied

# SUBJECTIVE HAPPINESS SCALE (also known as General Happiness Scale)

## Reference:

Lyubomirsky, S. & Lepper, H. S. (1999). A measure of subjective happiness: Preliminary reliability and construct validation. *Social Indicators Research*, 46, 137-155.

## Description of Measure:

A 4-item scale designed to measure subjective happiness. Each of item is completed by choosing one of 7 options that finish a given sentence fragment. The options are different for each of the four questions (see below for actual items).

## Abstracts of Selected Related Articles:

Lyubomirsky, S. & Tucker, K. L. (1998). Implications of Individual Differences in Subjective Happiness for Perceiving, Interpreting, and Thinking About Life Events. *Motivation and Emotion*, 22, 155-186.

Both anecdotal and empirical evidence suggest that characteristically happy and daily situations. This paper reports two questionnaire studies and a laboratory study testing the hypothesis that happy people perceive, interpret, and think about the same events in more positive ways than do unhappy ones. The results of Study 1 showed that students nominated by their peers as "very happy" reported experiencing similar types of both positive and negative life events, as did peer-nominated "unhappy" students. However, self-rated happy students tended to think about both types of events more favorably and adaptively—e.g., by seeing humor in adversity and emphasizing recent improvement in their lives. This pattern of results was conceptually replicated in Study 2 using hypothetical events. In Study 3, self-rated happy students interacted with a female confederate in the laboratory, then watched a series of videotapes depicting a fellow (but unfamiliar) student in three different situations. Happy individuals liked the person they met, and recalled her in more favorable terms, more than did unhappy ones. The same pattern of results, albeit weaker, was found for liking of the videotaped target. Implications of our findings for the question of how happiness (or unhappiness) is maintained are discussed.

Seligman, M. E. P., Steen, T. A., Park, N., & Peterson, C. (2005). Positive psychology progress: Empirical validation of interventions. *American Psychologist*, 60, 410-421.

Positive psychology has flourished in the last 5 years. The authors review recent developments in the field, including books, meetings, courses, and conferences. They also discuss the newly created classification of character strengths and virtues, a positive complement to the various editions of the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (e. g., American Psychiatric Association, 1994), and present some cross-cultural findings that suggest a surprising ubiquity of strengths and virtues. Finally, the authors focus on psychological interventions that increase individual happiness. In a 6-group, random-assignment, placebo controlled Internet

study, the authors tested 5 purported happiness interventions and 1 plausible control exercise. They found that 3 of the interventions lastingly increased happiness and decreased depressive symptoms. Positive interventions can supplement traditional interventions that relieve suffering and may someday be the practical legacy of positive psychology.

Schwartz, B., Ward, A., Monterosso, J., Lyubomirsky, S., White, K., & Lehman, D. R. (2002). Maximizing versus satisficing: Happiness is a matter of choice. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 83, 1178-1197.

Can people feel worse off as the options they face increase? The present studies suggest that some people—maximizers—can. Study 1 reported a Maximization Scale, which measures individual differences in desire to maximize. Seven samples revealed negative correlations between maximization and happiness, optimism, self-esteem, and life satisfaction, and positive correlations between maximization and depression, perfectionism, and regret. Study 2 found maximizers less satisfied than nonmaximizers (satisficers) with consumer decisions, and more likely to engage in social comparison. Study 3 found maximizers more adversely affected by upward social comparison. Study 4 found maximizers more sensitive to regret and less satisfied in an ultimatum bargaining game. The interaction between maximizing and choice is discussed in terms of regret, adaptation, and self-blame.

### Scale:

*Instructions:* For each of the following statements and/or questions, please circle the point on the scale that you feel is most appropriate in describing you.

1. In general, I consider myself:

not a very happy person      1      2      3      4      5      6      7 a very happy person

2. Compared to most of my peers, I consider myself:

less happy      1      2      3      4      5      6      7 more happy

3. Some people are generally very happy. They enjoy life regardless of what is going on, getting the most out of everything. To what extent does this characterization describe you?

not at all      1      2      3      4      5      6      7 a great deal

4. Some people are generally not very happy. Although they are not depressed, they never seem as happy as they might be. To what extent does this characterization describe you?

not at all      1      2      3      4      5      6      7 a great deal

### Scoring:

Sum the scores for each item together. Keep scores continuous.

## **Scale of Positive and Negative Experience (SPANE)**

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Please think about what you have been doing and experiencing during the past four weeks. Then report how much you experienced each of the following feelings, using the scale below. For each item, select a number from 1 to 5, and indicate that number on your response sheet.

1. Very Rarely or Never
2. Rarely
3. Sometimes
4. Often
5. Very Often or Always

Positive

Negative

Good

Bad

Pleasant

Unpleasant

Happy

Sad

Afraid

Joyful

Angry

Contented

### **Scoring:**

The measure can be used to derive an overall affect balance score, but can also be divided into positive and negative feelings scales.

**Positive Feelings (SPANE-P):** Add the scores, varying from 1 to 5, for the six items: positive, good, pleasant, happy, joyful, and contented. The score can vary from 6 (lowest possible) to 30 (highest positive feelings score).

**Negative Feelings (SPANE-N):** Add the scores, varying from 1 to 5, for the six items: negative, bad, unpleasant, sad, afraid, and angry. The score can vary from 6 (lowest possible) to 30 (highest negative feelings score).

**Affect Balance (SPANE-B):** The negative feelings score is subtracted from the positive feelings score, and the resultant difference score can vary from -24 (unhappiest possible) to 24 (highest affect balance possible). A respondent with a very high score of 24 reports that she or he rarely or never experiences any of the negative feelings, and very often or always has all of the positive feelings.

## HEMA QUESTIONNAIRE

Peoples' ways of conceptualizing and seeking a "good life" tend to fall into three categories:

- \* **Hedonic orientation** – pleasure/enjoyment, comfort
- \* **Eudaimonic orientation** – authenticity/autonomy, excellence/virtue, growth/maturation/self-actualization, meaning/contribution
- \* **Extrinsic orientation** – material wealth, status, power, fame, popularity

**Instructions to the trait version:** To what degree do you typically approach your activities with each of the following intentions, whether or not you actually achieve your aim?

**Instructions to state versions:**

To what degree did you approach your current activity with each of the following intentions, whether or not you actually achieve your aim?

**The items are rated from 1 (not at all) to 7 (very much)**

Seeking relaxation?

2. Seeking to develop a skill, learn, or gain insight into something?
3. Seeking to do what you believe in?
4. Seeking pleasure?
5. Seeking to pursue excellence or a personal ideal?
6. Seeking enjoyment?
7. Seeking to take it easy?
8. Seeking to use the best in yourself?
9. Seeking fun?
10. Seeking to contribute to others or the surrounding world?
11. Seeking to have lots of money and nice possessions?
12. Seeking to have high status and prestige?
13. Seeking power and dominance over others?
14. Seeking to be admired and well-known?
15. Seeking to be popular and have an attractive social image?
- (16. OPTIONAL ITEM: Seeking to have things comfortable?)

The **eudaimonic motivation** scale consists of items 2, 3, 5, 8, 10

The **hedonic motivation** scale consists of items 1, 4, 6, 7, 9

The **hedonic pleasure motivation** subscale consists of items 4, 6, 9

The **hedonia comfort motivation** subscale consists of items 1, 7, AND ITEM 16

The 16<sup>th</sup> OPTIONAL ITEM is to be included only when a researcher wishes to assess hedonia comfort separately from hedonia pleasure and have a three-item scale to reach sufficient internal consistency; otherwise, the item is excluded, so that the overall hedonia concept is more heavily weighted toward hedonia pleasure

The **extrinsic orientation/motivation** scale consists of items 11, 12, 13, 14, 15

Hedonia and eudaimonia represent the two main healthy ways of pursuing fulfillment in life. However, many people pursue a third set of aims, even if it relates negatively to well-being. This third category consists of what are called extrinsic motives, as identified by self-determination theory researchers (Kasser & Ryan, 1993, 1996). Extrinsic motives include material wealth, status, power, fame, and popularity.



Kasser, T., & Ryan, R.M. (1993). A dark side of the American dream: Correlates of financial success as a central life aspiration. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 65, 410–422.

Kasser, T., & Ryan, R. M. (1996). Further examining the American dream: Differential correlates of intrinsic and extrinsic goals. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 22, 281-288.

The five additional items (items 11-15) that make up the HEEMA have been adapted in part from the extrinsic motives in Kasser & Ryan (1996), and in part from the egoistic values in de Groot and Steg (2008).

de Groot, J. I. M., & Steg, L. (2008). Value orientations to explain beliefs related to environmental significant behavior: How to measure egoistic, altruistic, and biospheric value orientations. *Environment and Behavior*, 40, 330-354.

The first paper to use the HEEMA and to report its psychometric properties is:

Lefebvre, A., & Huta, V. (2021). Age and gender differences in eudaimonic, hedonic, and extrinsic motivations.

*Journal of Happiness Studies*, 22, 2299-2321.

### **The Gratitude Questionnaire – Six Item Form (GQ-6)**

The Gratitude Questionnaire-Six-Item Form (GQ-6) is a six-item self-report questionnaire designed to assess individual differences in the proneness to experience gratitude in daily life.

McCullough, M. E., Emmons, R. A., & Tsang, J. (2002). The grateful disposition: A conceptual and empirical topography. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 82, 112-127.

Instructions: Using the scale below as a guide, write a number beside each statement to indicate how much you agree with it.

- 1 = strongly disagree
- 2 = disagree
- 3 = slightly disagree
- 4 = neutral
- 5 = slightly agree
- 6 = agree
- 7 = strongly agree

- \_\_\_\_ 1. I have so much in life to be thankful for.
- \_\_\_\_ 2. If I had to list everything that I felt grateful for, it would be a very long list.
- \_\_\_\_ 3. When I look at the world, I don't see much to be grateful for.
- \_\_\_\_ 4. I am grateful to a wide variety of people.
- \_\_\_\_ 5. As I get older I find myself more able to appreciate the people, events, and situations that have been part of my life history.
- \_\_\_\_ 6. Long amounts of time can go by before I feel grateful to something or someone.

Scoring: Compute a mean across the item ratings; items 3 and 6 are reverse-scored.

Kasser, T., & Ryan, R.M. (1993). A dark side of the American dream: Correlates of financial success as a central life aspiration. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 65, 410–422.

Kasser, T., & Ryan, R. M. (1996). Further examining the American dream: Differential correlates of intrinsic and extrinsic goals. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 22, 281-288.

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*Journal of Happiness Studies*, 22, 2299-2321.

## Workplace Subjective Wellbeing (WSWB)

For each of these questions please give an answer on a scale from 0 to 10, where 0 is “not at all” and 10 is “completely.”

- Overall, how satisfied are you with your job? [0-10]
- Overall, how purposeful and meaningful do you find your work? [0-10]
- How happy did you feel while at work during the past week? [0-10]
- How stressed did you feel while at work during the past week? [0-10]

Source: <https://ora.ox.ac.uk/objects/uuid:fedcfcaf-6b31-485a-891f-243acc0b3abd/files/s7d278v399>

## The International Positive and Negative Affect Schedule Short Form (I-PANAS-SF) Question,

Measure, and Item Order Question: Thinking about yourself and how you normally feel, to what extent do you generally feel on a scale of 1 to 5 where 1 is very slightly or not at all and 5 is extremely:

Items in order:

- Upset
- Hostile
- Alert
- Ashamed
- Inspired
- Nervous
- Determined
- Attentive
- Afraid
- Active

| 1                           | 2        | 3          | 4           | 5         |
|-----------------------------|----------|------------|-------------|-----------|
| Very slightly or not at all | A little | Moderately | Quite a bit | Extremely |

Interval measure: never 1 2 3 4 5 always

Source: Thompson, E. R. (2007). Development and Validation of an Internationally Reliable Short-Form of the Positive and Negative Affect Schedule (PANAS). *Journal of Cross-Cultural Psychology*, 38(2), 227-242. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1177/0022022106297301>